LEFI SHAN

Legal name: Kevin Shan | GAME, LEVEL & TECHNICAL DESIGNER (LEVEL · COMBAT 3C · SYSTEMS)

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Portfolio: leficious.com | Watch 2026 Reel

Game, level, and technical designer building spatial puzzle architecture, combat 3C, and gameplay systems in Unity 6 and Unreal Engine 5, backed by Maya 3D modeling/rigging, environment production, and Python pipeline tooling.

SELECTED TECHNICAL & LEVEL DESIGN PROJECTS

Still Life | Play on itch.io | Trailer | GDD | 1-Page Pitch — 2026

Solo Unity 6 prototype | Multi-floor puzzle & level design, C# companion AI, Maya rigging, and HLSL shaders

• Architected a 200m, 5-room surrealist puzzle facility—anchored by a 3-story, 4-stage counterweight atrium requiring 100% allocation of a 235 kg animal pool across elevators, gap bridges, optical focus lenses, and gates—conditioning player habits for a wordless finale reversal.

• Engineered a 5-state C# Desk Lamp companion AI on an 18-joint Maya rig (procedural walk, flashbang flee, shivering, petting recovery), paired with zero-HUD tri-color floor conduit shaders, cold-vent/crusher gates, and HLSL printmaking post-processing (200+ FPS).

An Echo Has No Shape | Play on itch.io | Trailer | 5-Page GDD — 2026

Solo 4-week Unity 6 prototype | Single-verb C# regional rulesets, level design, and 4-scale sightless wayfinding

• Built a continuous 550m × 550m sightless acoustic labyrinth around a single echolocation input (Press E) connecting a central hub and three regional puzzles with zero HUD markers, minimaps, or loading screens, guided by a 4-scale non-UI wayfinding hierarchy.

• Scripted three regional C# rulesets that recontextualize the single ping without new controls—Siren phantom ice decoys, sequential 3-wing city loops, and 3.0s silence gates—adding a wave-clash cue after playtests showed E-spamming so players discover the pause rule.

Fallen Valkyrie — 2025

Solo 10-week UE5 prototype | Combat 3C state machines, directional hit reactions, and multi-phase StateTree Boss AI

• Designed a playable boss stage around unarmed, spear, and bow combat, weapon-dependent lock-on targeting (sphere trace vs. over-the-shoulder aim camera), delayed-regen stamina/mana pacing, and dot-product directional hit reactions.

• Implemented layered upper/lower-body Animation Blueprints, Anim Notify socket collision windows, Motion Warping, Kawaii Physics secondary motion, and reusable StateTree tasks with a mid-fight invulnerable aerial phase.

Starshore — 2025

Solo 15-week UE5 prototype | Dual-mode locomotion 3C, GAS combat, and box-garden exploration

• Built ground and high-speed flight locomotion, dash cancels, and a 5-hit combo; double-tap forward blends into flight and release or interruption transitions smoothly back to ground movement.

• Designed passive spell targeting within a 750-unit, 45-degree camera cone; connected GAS abilities (Attributes, Effects, Tags), physics-impulse loot, inventory, and dynamic grid vendors into one playable loop.

Grid-Based Tactical RPG Template — 2026

Solo UE5 systems prototype | Blueprint and UMG level-authoring tools

• Implemented a snappable tactical grid, A* pathfinding, Dijkstra movement ranges, and path-cost previews alongside a UMG grid-authoring and passability debugging tool with reusable data-driven unit, class, and Animation Blueprint templates.

ADDITIONAL 3D PRODUCTION, TECHNICAL ART & PIPELINE WORK

Stylize Normals Toolkit v3.0 & 3D Environment / Rigging Pipeline — 2025-26

Autodesk Maya, Python, Maya API, Unreal Engine 5, Houdini | Open-source tool, environment lighting, and rigging/animation

• Developed an open-source multi-target Maya toolkit for generating, transferring, previewing, and repairing custom foliage/vertex normals; built stylized UE5 environments (Sacred Forest, Water Blossoms with RVT terrain & Houdini snow) and Maya IK/FK character rigs & animations.

EDUCATION

University of Southern California | M.S., Game Design and Development | Expected May 2028
Gnomon School of Visual Effects | B.F.A., Digital Production - Games (Featured in Student Reel) | June 2025

TOOLS AND SKILLS

Level, Gameplay & Combat Design: Unity 6 (C#, URP), Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints, GAS, StateTree, Enhanced Input, UMG), multi-floor puzzle & box-garden layout, 3C & combat feel, non-UI spatial wayfinding, iterative playtesting, data-driven systems

3D Production, Animation & Code: Maya (3D modeling, IK/FK rigging, keyframe animation, Maya API), Animation Blueprints, Motion Warping, Anim Notifies, C#, Python, C++, HLSL/URP shaders, ZBrush, Substance 3D, Houdini, SpeedTree, Gaea, Niagara VFX, Git, Perforce

AI-Assisted Workflows: Antigravity, Codex (code & rapid engine prototyping); Stable Diffusion (ComfyUI, Automatic1111), chaiNNer (image generation & upscaling); Meshy AI (3D mesh generation), Suno (music), ElevenLabs (SFX & voice)